FOLFOX-4

FOLFOX-4 may be given after surgery for stage II or III colon cancer, or for colorectal cancer that has spread. Your team explains the aim, alternatives and how benefit will be reviewed.

Colorectal cancer · NCCP 00210 v9b · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

My overall treatment

Day 1: oxaliplatin and folinic acid, then fluorouracil bolus and a 22-hour infusion. Day 2: further fluorouracil bolus and a second 22-hour infusion; completion around Day 3. A repeating 14-day cycle. For adjuvant FOLFOX-4, NCCP describes 12 cycles; metastatic treatment continues while suitable.

A 14-day reference cycle

Day 1: oxaliplatin and folinic acid, then fluorouracil bolus and a 22-hour infusion. Day 2: further fluorouracil bolus and a second 22-hour infusion; completion around Day 3. A repeating 14-day cycle. For adjuvant FOLFOX-4, NCCP describes 12 cycles; metastatic treatment continues while suitable.

Your treatment schedule

Day 1	Day 2 → Day 3	Days 4–14
Oxaliplatin / folinic acid, then fluorouracil bolus + first 22-hour infusion.	Further fluorouracil bolus + second 22-hour infusion; completion as arranged.	Recovery and review. Adjuvant plan: 12 cycles; metastatic duration is individual.

Your team confirms the active phase and dates. Symptoms may occur during or after treatment; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**DPD / baseline bloods** Required by regimen	DPD before fluoropyrimidine; blood count, kidney and liver tests.
During	**Bloods / nerves** Required by regimen	Blood count, kidney and liver tests before each cycle. Formal nerve review every two cycles; report symptoms sooner.
If indicated	**Heart** Conditional tests	ECG if cardiac function is compromised.
After / review	**Recovery / scans / markers** Team-agreed plan	Follow the individual cancer plan and any unresolved effects; scan and marker intervals are team-agreed.

Between treatments

- No guaranteed safe days: report fever, sudden illness, diarrhoea or poor intake promptly.
- Symptoms can continue after pump removal and after treatment ends.
- FOLFOX4 uses two 22-hour infusions, not the single 46-hour mFOLFOX6 pump schedule.

Confirm supportive medicines, tests, working urgent contacts and pump disconnection.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Nerves

Oxaliplatin

Cold-triggered tingling or difficulty with buttons/walking: report.

2 Mouth / swallowing

Fluorouracil

Pain or ulcers affecting eating or drinking need advice.

3 Breathing / reaction

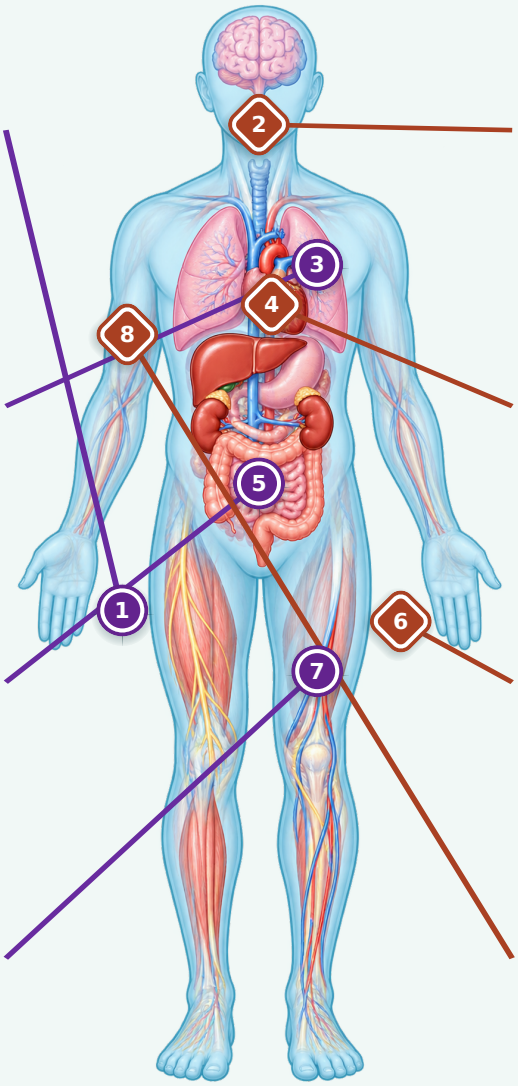
Treatment

New breathing difficulty requires prompt assessment.

4 Chest

Fluorouracil

New chest pain needs urgent assessment.



5 Bowel

Treatment

Diarrhoea, increased stoma output or dehydration: call early.

6 Skin / nails

Fluorouracil

Report troublesome skin changes or painful hands/feet.

7 Blood / infection

Treatment

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Line / pump

Treatment delivery

Pain, swelling, leakage or a loose connection needs immediate advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

New breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse, severe diarrhoea or inability to drink require prompt assessment. Call for line pain, swelling, leakage or unexpected pump progress.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

FOLFOX-4

Every 14 days · two successive 22-hour fluorouracil infusions · course length confirmed by team.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.